

ODM-008 — Investigation

Status: Foundational

Authority: Methodology

Depends on:

- ODM-000 through ODM-007
 - OCS-000 through OCS-032
 - OAS-000 through OAS-031
 - OIS-000 through OIS-019
 - OGD-000 through OGD-023
-

Purpose

This specification defines the constitutional role of Investigation within the Organodynamics Discovery Methodology.

An Investigation is the disciplined process through which a Hypothesis is examined using one or more appropriate methods of inquiry.

The methodology SHALL not privilege experimentation over other constitutionally valid forms of evidence.

The objective is not to perform a particular method.

The objective is to determine whether the available evidence supports, refines, limits, or rejects the current Hypothesis.

Investigation SHALL pursue understanding.

It SHALL not defend prior belief.

1. Objective

The objective of Investigation is to obtain reliable evidence capable of evaluating a Hypothesis according to the previously established Evaluation Criteria.

Investigation SHALL preserve:

Methodological rigor.

Evidence integrity.

Transparency.

Repeatability.

Historical accountability.

2. Definition

An Investigation is a documented methodological process designed to gather, analyze, or generate evidence relevant to one or more Hypotheses.

An Investigation MAY employ one or more investigative methods.

The chosen methods SHALL be justified.

3. Investigation Methods

Investigation MAY include:

Controlled experimentation.

Simulation.

Historical analysis.

Comparative analysis.

Formal reasoning.

Architectural analysis.

Implementation studies.

Observational studies.

Case analysis.

Future methodological approaches MAY be introduced through constitutional evolution.

Method selection SHALL be appropriate to the Problem Frame.

4. Investigation Plan

Every Investigation SHALL preserve:

The associated Problem Frame.

The associated Hypothesis.

Applicable Evaluation Criteria.

Chosen investigative methods.

Required evidence.

Known limitations.

Expected outputs.

The Investigation Plan SHALL be documented before evidence collection begins whenever reasonably possible.

5. Evidence Collection

Evidence SHALL be collected in a manner that preserves:

Provenance.

Context.

Integrity.

Reproducibility.

Known uncertainty.

Conflicting evidence SHALL be preserved rather than discarded.

6. Investigation Outcomes

An Investigation MAY conclude that a Hypothesis is:

Supported.

Partially supported.

Refined.

Inconclusive.

Contradicted.

Rejected.

The outcome SHALL describe the relationship between the evidence and the Hypothesis.

It SHALL not declare constitutional truth.

7. Historical Preservation

Every Investigation SHALL preserve:

Methods employed.

Evidence collected.

Analytical reasoning.

Intermediate findings.

Final assessment.

Known limitations.

The complete investigative history SHALL remain permanently reconstructable.

8. Verification

Verification SHALL demonstrate:

Methodological transparency.

Evidence integrity.

Compliance with Evaluation Criteria.

Historical continuity.

Independent reproducibility.

Investigation SHALL remain independently reviewable.

9. Investigation Test

An Investigation satisfies this specification when independent researchers, using the documented methods, evaluation criteria, and available evidence, consistently reach constitutionally compatible assessments regarding the explanatory status of the associated Hypothesis.

Conformance

An Investigation conforms to this specification when it applies appropriate investigative methods transparently, preserves evidence and reasoning, documents limitations, maintains historical traceability, and remains independently reproducible and reviewable.

Methodological Principle

Discovery advances not because one method is universally superior,

but because every method is used with discipline,

transparency,

and intellectual honesty.

Organodynamics therefore defines Investigation not by the tools it employs,

but by the integrity with which evidence is gathered,

examined,

and allowed to challenge even the most promising hypotheses.

End of Specification ODM-008